

man wanted to pass from one of these divisions to the other, he had to cross in a boat ; which must, it seems to me, have been very troublesome. Accordingly, while she was digging the lake, Nitocris bethought herself of turning it to a use which should at once remove this inconvenience, and enable her to leave another monument of her reign over Babylon. She gave orders for the hewing of immense blocks of stone, and when they were ready and the basin was excavated, she turned the entire stream of the Euphrates into the cutting, and thus for a time, while the basin was filling, the natural channel of the river was left dry. Forthwith she set to work, and in the first place lined the banks of the stream within the city with quays of burnt brick, and also bricked the landing-places opposite the river-gates, adopting throughout the same fashion of brickwork which had been used in the town wall ; after which, with the materials which had been prepared, she built, as near the middle of the town as possible, a stone bridge, the blocks whereof were bound together with iron and lead. In the daytime square wooden platforms were laid along from pier to pier, on which the inhabitants crossed the stream ; but at night they were withdrawn, to prevent people passing from side to side in the dark to commit robberies. When the river had filled the cutting, and the bridge was finished, the Euphrates was turned back again into its ancient bed ; and thus the basin, transformed suddenly into a lake, was seen to answer the purpose for which it was made, and the inhabitants, by help of the basin, obtained the advantage of a bridge.

187. It was this same princess by whom a remarkable deception was planned. She had her tomb constructed in the upper part of one of the principal gateways of the city, high above the heads of the passers by, with this inscription cut upon it :—“ If there be one among my successors on the throne of Babylon who is in want of treasure, let him open my tomb, and take as much as he chooses,—not, however, unless he be truly in want, for it will not be for his good.” This tomb continued untouched until Darius came to the kingdom. To him it seemed a monstrous thing that he should be unable to use one of the gates of the town, and that a sum of money should be lying idle, and moreover inviting his grasp, and he not seize upon it. Now he could not use the gate because, as he drove through, the dead body would have been over his head. Accordingly he opened the tomb ; but instead of money, found only the dead body, and a writing which said—“ Hadst thou not been insatiate of pelf, and careless how thou gottest it, thou wouldst not have broken open the sepulchres of the dead.”

188. The expedition of Cyrus was undertaken against the son of this princess, who bore the same name as his father Labynetus,² and was king of the Assyrians. The Great King, when he goes to the wars, is always supplied with provisions carefully prepared at home, and with cattle of his own. Water too from the river Choaspes, which flows by Susa,³ is taken with him for his drink, as that is the only water which the kings of Persia taste.⁴ Wherever he travels, he is attended by a number of four-wheeled cars drawn by mules, in which the Choaspes water, ready boiled for use, and stored in flagons of silver, is moved with him from place to place.

189. Cyrus on his way to Babylon came to the banks of the Gyndes,⁵ a stream which, rising in the Matienian mountains,⁶ runs through the country of the Dardanians,⁷ and empties itself

² Herodotus probably regards this Labynetus as the son of the king mentioned in chap. 74.

³ For a description of the situation and present state of Susa, see note on Book iii. ch. 68. There is no doubt that the Choaspes is the modern *Kerkhah*. (See *Journal of the Geogr. Soc.*, vol. ix. part i. pp. 88, 89.)

⁴ This statement of Herodotus is echoed by various writers (Plutarch, de Exil. vol. ii. p. 601, D; Athenæus, Deipnosoph. ii. 23, p. 171; Solinus, Polyhist. xli. p. 83; Eustath. ad Dionys. Perieg. 1073, &c.). Some add to it, that no one but the king (Solin. l. s. c.), or no one but the king and his eldest son (Agathocles, Fr. 5), might drink the Choaspes water. What most say of the Choaspes, Strabo reports of the Eulæus (xv. p. 1043), and Pliny (H. N. xxxi. 3) mentions both names. But these two writers are probably mistaken in regarding the Eulæus and Choaspes as different rivers. The term Eulæus (Ulai of Daniel) seems to have been applied to the *Kerkhah* from Susa to its junction with the *Karun*. The water of both the *Karun* and the *Kerkhah* is said at the present day to be excellent, and the natives vaunt the superiority of these two rivers over all other streams or springs in the world (*Journal of Geogr. Society*, vol. ix. part i. p. 89).

⁵ The Gyndes is undoubtedly the *Diyálah*, since,—firstly,—there is no other navigable stream after the lower Zab on the road between Sardis and Susa (vide infra, v. 52); and secondly, no other river of any consequence could have to be crossed between the mountains and the Tigris on the march from Agbatana to Babylon. Were it not for these circumstances the river *Gangér*, which is actually divided at Mendalli into a multitude of petty streams, and completely absorbed in irrigation, might seem to have a better claim (*Journal of Geogr. Soc.* ut sup. p. 46).

⁶ These Matieni are not to be confounded with the Matieni of Asia Minor, who may have been of the same race (query, Medes? the *d* of Mada passing into *t*, as in Sauro-matæ), but were a distinct people. Herodotus seems to assign to these Matieni the whole of the mountain range from the sources of the *Diyálah* near Hamadâr to those of the *Aras* (Araxes) near Erzeroum in Upper Armenia (vide infra, ch. 202).

[The term Matieni may perhaps mean simply "mountaineers." The Babylonian word, at any rate, which is used for a mountain may be read as *matu* in the singular, and *matiya* or *matein* in the plural. There is, however, no cognate term in any of the other Semitic languages.—H. C. R.]

⁷ No other writer mentions Dardanians in these parts. It has been proposed to read διὰ Δαραίων, —δι' Ἀρμενίων,—and διὰ Δαρνέων. The only various reading in the MSS. favours the last emendation. It is διαρδανέων, which has all the letters of διὰ Δαρνέων with a single dislocation. The ruins of *Darneh* still exist on the

into the river Tigris. The Tigris, after receiving the Gyndes, flows on by the city of Opis,⁸ and discharges its waters into the Erythræan sea. When Cyrus reached this stream, which could only be passed in boats, one of the sacred white horses accompanying his march, full of spirit and high mettle, walked into the water, and tried to cross by himself; but the current seized him, swept him along with it, and drowned him in its depths. Cyrus, enraged at the insolence of the river, threatened so to break its strength that in future even women should cross it easily without wetting their knees. Accordingly he put off for a time his attack on Babylon, and, dividing his army into two parts, he marked out by ropes one hundred and eighty trenches on each side of the Gyndes, leading off from it in all directions, and setting his army to dig, some on one side of the river, some on the other, he accomplished his threat by the aid of so great a number of hands, but not without losing thereby the whole summer season.

190. Having, however, thus wreaked his vengeance on the Gyndes⁹ by dispersing it through three hundred and sixty chan-

banks of the Zamacân before it joins the Diyâlah, and before the united rivers issue from the mountains into the plain of *Shahrizûr*.

[It must be confessed, however, that *Darneh* has not been a place of any consequence either in the ancient or modern geography of the country. It was merely selected by the Kurdish emirs for their residence about five centuries back on account of the strength of the position. *Δαρδάνεοι* may very well mean "the holders of the passes," and thus exactly apply to the tribes along the banks of the upper *Diyâlah*.—H. C. R.]

⁸ This is the plain meaning of Herodotus, who has therefore been accused of ignorance by Rennell (*Geography of Herod.* § 9, p. 202). But the situation of Opis is uncertain. Strabo, by calling it an emporium (xvi. p. 1051) might lead us to imagine that its position was low down the river. Xenophon's narrative (*Anab.* ii. iv. 13-25), it must be granted, makes this impossible. Still, however, Opis may have been a little below the junction of the Diyâlah with the Tigris, or at the point of confluence.

[If we remember that Xenophon's Median Wall is the enceinte of Babylon, and that the Greeks crossed the Tigris at Sittacé, which was on the road from Babylon to Susa, we can hardly fail of identifying the *Diyâlah* with the Phycus of Xenophon (*Anab.* ii. iv. 25), and thus recognising Opis in the ruins of *Khafaji*, near the confluence of the two rivers. The name of Phycus probably comes from *Hupuska*, the title in the inscriptions of the district of *Sulimanieh*, through which the Diyâlah flows. In the name of Opis we have probably a Greek nominative ending as in *Is*. The cuneiform orthography is *Hupiya*, and I rather think that *Khafaji* is a mere corruption of the original name. The name of Sittacé, or, more properly, Psittacé, is written in the inscriptions as *Patsita*, without the Scythic guttural termination. It appears to have been situated at least as low down as the modern fort of the Zobeid chief.—H. C. R.]

⁹ Rennell sensibly remarks (p. 202) that the story of Cyrus's dividing the Gyndes is a very childish one, *in the manner in which it is told*. He supposes that the river was swollen, and that the sole object of Cyrus was to effect the passage. But this explanation is unsatisfactory. It is not conceivable that Cyrus proceeded against Babylon unprepared for the passage of great rivers. Boats must have abounded on the streams, and rafts supported by inflated skins, which were in constant use upon

nels, Cyrus, with the first approach of the ensuing spring, marched forward against Babylon. The Babylonians, encamped without their walls, awaited his coming. A battle was fought at a short distance from the city, in which the Babylonians were defeated by the Persian king, whereupon they withdrew within their defences. Here they shut themselves up, and made light of his siege, having laid in a store of provisions for many years in preparation against this attack; for when they saw Cyrus conquering nation after nation, they were convinced that he would never stop, and that their turn would come at last.

191. Cyrus was now reduced to great perplexity, as time went on and he made no progress against the place. In this distress either some one made the suggestion to him, or he bethought himself of a plan, which he proceeded to put in execution. He placed a portion of his army at the point where the

them, as the Nimrud sculptures show, could have been constructed rapidly. Even if it had been necessary to divide the Gyndes, in order to make it fordable, there would have been no need of entirely dispersing it, and so wasting a whole summer. And if this was the only means by which Cyrus could pass the comparatively small stream of the Diyálah, how did he get across the Tigris?

If we accept the fact of the dispersion, the true explanation would seem to be, that Cyrus had already resolved to attempt the capture of Babylon by the means which he subsequently adopted, and thought it necessary to practise his army in the art of draining off the waters from a stream of moderate size before attempting the far greater work of making the Euphrates fordable. He may not have been aware of the artificial reservoir which rendered his task at Babylon comparatively easy, or not have anticipated the neglect which converted a means of defence to the assailed into a convenience to the assailing party.

It is remarkable that Mr. Grote accepts the narrative of Herodotus as it stands, apparently seeing in it no improbability. At least he offers no explanation of the conduct of Cyrus (Hist. of Greece, vol. iv. pp. 284-5).

[I incline to regard the whole story as a fable, embodying some popular tradition with regard to the origin of the great hydraulic works on the *Diyálah* below the Hamaran hills, where the river has been dammed across to raise the level of the water, and a perfect network of canals have been opened out from it on either side. The principal of these canals to the east, now named *Beladroz* (*Bapápoð* in Theophrastes, and *Baraz rud*, or "hog river," of the Arabs), is apparently of extreme antiquity, the stream having worked itself a bed in the alluvial soil nearly 50 feet below the level of the country. There are fully 360 streams of water derived from the *Diyálah*, including all the branch cuts from the seven great canals. If Cyrus did indeed execute these works, his object must have been to furnish means of irrigation to the country, and such a motive was scarcely likely to have influenced him when he was conducting a hostile expedition against Babylon. Moreover, if he marched upon Babylon by the high road leading from the Persian mountains, he would have had no occasion to cross the *Diyálah* at all. The direct route must have followed the left bank of the river to Opis, near which was the passage of the Tigris.

The name of the river Gyndes is probably derived from the cuneiform *Khudun*, a city and district on the banks of the river adjoining *Hupuska*, which is mentioned in the annals of Sardanapalus. It is at any rate worthy of remark that all the names by which this river has been known in modern times, *Tamerra*, *Shirvan*, *Nahrwan*, and *Diyálah*, are those of cities on its banks, and the same system of nomenclature may very well be supposed to have existed in antiquity.—H. C. R.]

river enters the city, and another body at the back of the place where it issues forth, with orders to march into the town by the bed of the stream, as soon as the water became shallow enough: he then himself drew off with the unwarlike portion of his host, and made for the place where Nitocris dug the basin for the river, where he did exactly what she had done formerly: he turned the Euphrates by a canal into the basin,¹ which was then a marsh, on which the river sank to such an extent that the natural bed of the stream became fordable. Hereupon the Persians who had been left for the purpose at Babylon by the river-side, entered the stream, which had now sunk so as to reach about midway up a man's thigh, and thus got into the town. Had the Babylonians been apprised of what Cyrus was about, or had they noticed their danger, they would not have allowed the entrance of the Persians within the city, which was what ruined them utterly, but would have made fast all the street-gates which gave upon the river, and mounting upon the walls along both sides of the stream, would so have caught the enemy as it were in a trap. But, as it was, the Persians came upon them by surprise and so took the city. Owing to the vast size of the place, the inhabitants of the central parts (as the residents at Babylon declare) long after the outer portions of the town were taken, knew nothing of what had chanced, but as they were engaged in a festival, continued dancing and revelling until they learnt the capture but too certainly. Such, then, were the circumstances of the first taking of Babylon.²

192. Among many proofs which I shall bring forward of the power and resources of the Babylonians, the following is of special account. The whole country under the dominion of the Persians, besides paying a fixed tribute, is parcelled out into divisions, which have to supply food to the Great King and his army during different portions of the year.³ Now out of the twelve months which go to a year, the district of Babylon fur-

¹ Mr. Grote says that Cyrus "caused *another* reservoir and *another* canal of communication to be dug, by means of which he drew off the water of the Euphrates" (vol. iv. p. 285). But Herodotus says that he turned the river into the *same* reservoir—ἐς τὴν λίμνην—which was at the time a marsh—ἐοῦσαν ἑλος. And indeed, had he done otherwise, he would have expended time and labour very unnecessarily.

² Herodotus intends to contrast this *first* capture with the *second* capture by Darius Hystaspes, of which he speaks in the latter portion of the third Book. We learn, however, by the mode of speech used, that he was not aware of any former occasion on which the city of Babylon had been taken by an enemy.

³ See the Essay appended to Book iii., "On the Persian System of Administration and Government."

nishes food during four, the other regions of Asia during eight ; by which it appears that Assyria, in respect of resources, is one-third of the whole of Asia. Of all the Persian governments, or satrapies as they are called by the natives,⁴ this is by far the best. When Tritantæchmes, son of Artabazus,⁵ held it of the king, it brought him in an artaba of silver every day. The artaba is a Persian measure,⁶ and holds three chœnixes more than the medimnus of the Athenians. He also had, belonging to his own private stud, besides war-horses, eight hundred stallions and sixteen thousand mares, twenty to each stallion. Besides which he kept so great a number of Indian hounds,⁷ that four large villages of the plain were exempted from all other charges on condition of finding them in food.

⁴ The native orthography of the word, which the Greeks wrote *σατραπης*, is "khshatrapâ." It is found twice in the Behistun inscription (Col. III. l. 14 and l. 55). The etymology has been much disputed (see Gesen. Hebr. Lex. p. 41. Engl. ed.); but, as "khshatram" is used throughout the inscriptions for "crown" or "empire," we can scarcely be mistaken in regarding "khshatrapâ" as formed of the two roots "khshatram," and "pa." The latter word signifies in Sanscrit "to preserve, uphold," whence it appears that a Satrap is "one who upholds the crown." (Cf. Col. Rawlinson's Vocabulary of the ancient Persian language, pp. 116-7).

⁵ We hear of a Tritantæchmes, "son of Artabanus, brother of Darius Hystaspes," in Book vii. ch. 82, from which place it might appear that this passage should be corrected. But we cannot be sure that the same person is intended in both instances. Indeed, as Herodotus seems to speak of his own personal knowledge, it is probable that the Tritantæchmes here mentioned was Satrap of Babylon at the time of Herodotus's visit (about B. C. 450), in which case it is scarcely possible that he should have been the same person who 30 years before was one of the six superior generals of the army of Xerxes.

[The name of Tritantæchmes is of considerable interest because it points to the Vedic traditions, which the Persians brought with them from the Indus, and of the currency of which in the time of Xerxes we have thus distinct evidence. The name means "strong as Tritan"—this title, which etymologically means "three-bodied," being the Sanscrit and Zend form of the famous Feridun of Persian romance, who divided the world between his three sons, Selm, Tur, and Erij.—H. C. R.]

⁶ This is the same name as the *ardeb* of modern Egypt, and, like the *medimnus*, is a corn measure. The *ardeb* is nearly five English bushels, and contains 8 *med*. This, too, is the Latin *modius*, which last was equal to one-sixth of the Greek *medimnus*. But the *ardeb* differs in quantity from the *artaba*.

1 *medimnus* = 48 *chœnixes*, or 6 Latin *modii*.

1 *modius* = 8 *chœnixes*.

1 *artaba* = 51 *chœnixes* (48 + 3).

1 *artaba* = little more than 6½ *modii*.

1 *modius* = nearly 1 peck, English.

1 *artaba* = about 1½ bushel.—[G. W.]

⁷ Concerning these famous dogs see Bähr's Ctesias (Indic. Excerpt. § 5), and Arist. Hist. An. viii. 28.

Models of favourite dogs are frequently found in excavating the cities of Babylon. Some may be seen in the British Museum, obtained from the hunting palace of the son of Esar-Haddon at Nineveh. They are of small size, and are inscribed with the name of the dog, which is commonly a word indicative of their hunting prowess. The representation of an Indian dog (p. 257) is from a terra-cotta fragment found by Col. Rawlinson at Babylon.